

KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA SANGATHAN, VARANASI REGION

PRE- BOARD- I Examination-2024-25

CLASS: X

Max. Marks-80

Subject: ENGLISH COMMUNICATIVE (101)

TIME- 3 Hrs

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions very carefully and strictly follow them:

- ❖ **This question paper has 10 questions. All questions are compulsory.**
- ❖ **This question paper contains four sections: Section A: Reading Skills, Section B: Writing Skills Section C: Grammar Section D: Literature Textbook**
- ❖ **Attempt all questions based on specific instructions for each part. Write the correct question number and part thereof in your answer sheet.**
- ❖ **Separate instructions are given with each question/part, wherever necessary.**
- ❖ **Adhere to the prescribed word limit while answering the questions.**

SECTION A: READING SKILLS (22 MARKS)

1. Read the passage given below:

12

1. Hobbies help us grow as a person. The best way to have a new hobby is to try something new. All of us are unique, and this is the reason why our hobbies and interests are different. Once we find an activity we are passionate about, we can explore that activity more. When you get hooked, you will realize that your hobby has become an integral part of your life. Having a hobby that we enjoy brings us joy and refreshes us. Hobbies help us to manage our leisure and unplanned time more productively. It also affords you the opportunity to learn new skills in your work. But these are not the only benefits of having a hobby.

2. It feels great to be skilled and good at something, doesn't it? And this is what that makes you confident. It can take some time to develop your hobby so that you may be able to tell that you are skilled. But, the journey of experiencing your hobby is very rewarding in itself. With the exposure to different types of activities these days, it doesn't matter which activity you choose. Whether you are pursuing a craft, sports, puzzles, or skill development, your hobby should be a diversion and a passion. Simultaneously, if your hobby gives you a sense of purpose, then you will be more confident about challenging yourself in your hobby and help you prepare for learning new things at work.

3. Hobbies give you an opportunity to enhance your life. Hobbies allow you to de-stress yourself while remaining mentally productive. Having hobbies promotes better health and may lower the risk of having high blood pressure. Enjoying a few hours of your hobby a week can also reduce the risk of depression and dementia. Hobbies refocus your mind on to something that you enjoy doing. Hobbies that include physical activities create chemical changes in your body that help to reduce stress.

4. Even if it doesn't involve physical activities, you can still reap the benefits of having a hobby. Getting a short break from work and doing something you are passionate about can rejuvenate your mind and help prepare you to handle challenges in the future in a better way.

5. Hobbies may provide an opportunity for you to socialize with people and that can be an additional benefit for your overall well-being. You can connect with people who enjoy doing the same things that you do. You can meet new people, discuss your hobby and get connected to a bigger circle that may even help you turn your hobby into your profession. The internet provides numerous groups and forums to connect with people that enjoy doing the same things that you want to do.

6. Some hobbies require creativity and if you develop creativity through your hobby, it can be beneficial. Creativity can help you experience new things at school and work. The skill of being creative is essential in today's world.

Based on your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below:

I. When a person gets hooked on a hobby, he realises that : 1

- (a) it has become an integral part of our life.
- (b) it has much more benefits than we realised.
- (c) it is much more enjoyable to have a hobby.
- (d) it is quite essential for us to learn some skills through our hobbies.

II. No matter which sort of hobby you are pursuing, be it a craft, sports, puzzles, or skill development, your hobby should be : 1

- (a) useful for you in the long run.
- (b) a skill that improves your present circumstances.
- (c) a diversion and a passion.
- (d) followed through till the end.

III. The journey of experiencing a hobby is quite : 1

- (a) challenging for a person.
- (b) rewarding in itself.
- (c) demanding in itself.
- (d) inspirational for a person.

IV. State any one way through which hobbies enhance your life? 2

V. Getting a hobby means having a short break from work and doing something you are passionate about which can: 1

- (a) give you a peace of mind from all the other problems of daily hectic life and make you feel refreshed.
- (b) help you enhance and improve your skills and push you forward on your path to success.
- (c) make you enjoy and appreciate your life much more as you are happy pursuing what you love.
- (d) rejuvenate your mind and help prepare you to handle challenges in the future in a better way.

VI. List any two benefits of having a hobby. 2

VII. What is essential in today's world? 2

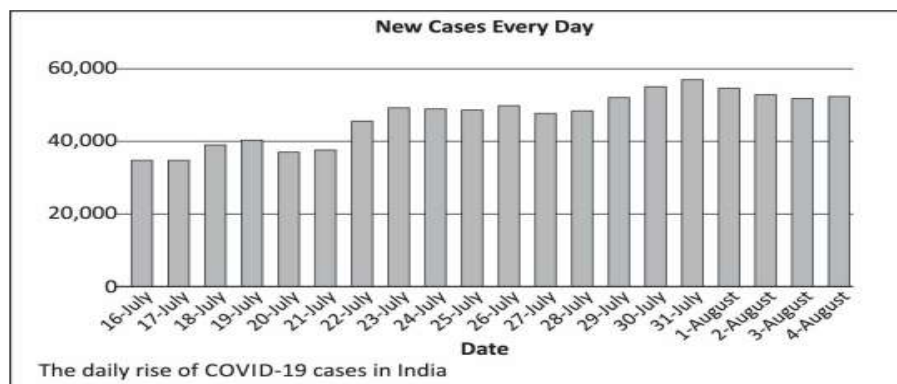
VIII. Supply 1 point to justify the following: 2

Hobby provides you with an opportunity to socialise with people.

2. Read the passage given below:

10

1. With novel Corona virus spreading rapidly all over the country, there are only three states right now, Meghalaya, Sikkim and Andaman and Nicobar Islands, that have less than 1,000 people infected with the disease.
2. Lakshadweep, of course, still hasn't reported even a single case till now, the only region in India entirely free of the epidemic.
3. Otherwise, even the relatively smaller states now have significantly large spread of the disease. Goa, for example, has seen more than 7,000 of its people infected by the virus till now. Tripura has over 5,500 cases, while Manipur has more than 3,000, and Nagaland a little less than 2,500. Puducherry has more than 4,000 cases, while even Daman and Diu has over 1,300 people infected.
4. And in each of these states, the numbers are rising at a fast pace, at a rate higher than the national level. The infections had initially reached these states in the first and second week of May, when the lockdown was relaxed for the first time to enable people stuck in different parts of the country to return to their native places.
5. After a period of very slow growth, the number of cases have begun to rise rapidly in the last one month. In Goa, for example, the total number of infected people has nearly doubled in the last 15 days. Same has happened in Puducherry, as well.
6. Tuesday was one of those rare occasions when the number of active cases in the country, those who are yet to recover from the disease, went down compared to the previous day. That is because the number of recoveries, combined with the number of deaths, exceeded the new cases that were detected on Tuesday.
7. With over 52,500 new cases detected in the country, the total number of infections crossed 19 lakh, out of which 12.82 lakh people have recovered from the disease. The number of dead is now close to 40,000.
8. The number of recoveries on Tuesday was the highest-ever for a single day. More than 51,700 people were declared to have been recovered. Three days earlier, the number of recoveries had crossed 50,000 for the first time, but in the next two days the number had fallen to much lower levels.



Based on your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below:

- I. How are these three states – Meghalaya, Sikkim and Andaman and Nicobar Islands – different from the rest of India? 2
- II. What is common among Goa, Tripura, Manipur, Nagaland, Puducherry and Daman and Diu? 2
- III. Which date in the graph shows the highest jump of detected cases in a day? 1
- IV. When had the number of recoveries crossed 50,000 for the first time? 1
- V. _____ is the only region in India which is entirely free of the epidemic. 1

- VI. Of the 19 lakh infected cases, how many have recovered? 1
 (i) 11.82 lakh
 (ii) 13.82 lakh
 (iii) 12.81 lakh
 (iv) 12.82 lakh
- VII. More than 51,700 people were declared to have been recovered on _____. 1
 (i) Wednesday
 (ii) Sunday
 (iii) Tuesday
 (iv) Monday
- VIII. Which word in the passage means the same as “quickly”? 1
 (i) rapidly
 (ii) significantly
 (iii) native
 (iv) rare

SECTION B: WRITING SKILLS (22 MARKS)

3. You are Nikhil / Nikita, HOD Home Science Department. Write an e-mail in about 50 words, to the principal of your school about the quality of food in the school canteen with some suggestions for healthy food. 3

4. Write a factual description, in not more than 100 words, of a potted plant that you and your sister recently chose to gift your father on his birthday. 4

5. A book fair was organised in your city, Varanasi. Thousands of people including a large number of students visited the fair. It aroused a great interest in reading and buying books. You want that such book fairs should be held in other cities of the state also to promote the habit of reading. Write a letter to the editor of a local newspaper giving your views, in not more than 120 words. You are Rohan/ Reena, H-148, Sunderpur, Varanasi. Use the ideas you may have gathered from MCB Unit 2: Education. 7

OR

5.B. You are Akash/ Akshara of Nehru colony, New Delhi. You recently visited Shimla with your family. You were perturbed to see the tourist throwing empty bottles and cans all over the place. Write a letter to the Editor of a National Newspaper in about 120 words expressing your concern and offering suggestions to improve the situation. Use ideas from Unit 4: Environment, along with your own to write this letter in not more than 120 words. 7

6.A. In today's competitive age, the students' main focus is on academics and coaching classes for entrance examinations, so they tend to neglect participation in outdoor games. Lack of open spaces is another reason for avoiding athletics and sports. Write an article on 'Poor Physical Fitness of School Students'.

Use the given cues, along with your own ideas and those you may have gathered from Unit 1: Health and Medicine. 8

Clues:

- Competitive world- focus on academics
- Adverse impact on health
- No participation in outdoor games
- Physical fitness ensures mental fitness

OR

6.B. A research conducted by the Centre for Studies on Inclusive Education (CSIE) Bristle, United Kingdom declared that, “Inclusive education is a human right and it makes good social sense.” On the basis of given cues, along with your own ideas and those you may have gathered from Unit 2: Education, write an article in about 150 words, on the topic: ‘Inclusive Education: A Human Approach. 8

Clues:

- All children have the right to learn together
- Children should not be discriminated by being excluded because of their disability or learning difficulty.
- Only inclusion has the potential to reduce fear and build friendship, respect and understanding.

SECTION C: GRAMMAR (10 MARKS)

7. Complete the tasks (A) to (C), as directed:

A) Fill in the blanks with appropriate option from those given in the brackets: (3x1=3)

Time travel (i)..... (ought to/ should /could) become a reality in the near future, (ii)..... (allows/allowed/allowing) human beings to experience the thrill of travelling back in time. However, (iii)..... (most/many/much) challenges must be overcome, such as ensuring safety and affordability for all potential time-travellers.

B) In the following paragraph, one word has been omitted in each line. In your answer sheets, remember to write the missing word along with the word that comes before and after it, as shown below. The first one has been done as an example. (4x1=4)

	word before	omission	word after
A man getting very impatient.	e.g. man	was	getting
Again and again, he would peep the	i)		
doctor’s room to see many patients	ii)		
were left. After a long time his turn	iii)		
came, he got up and said, Sorry, doctor,			
I don’t have problem now. This long	iv)		
wait has cured the headache.			

C) Do as directed : 3 marks

i) Rearrange the following jumbled/ phrases in the given information to create a meaningful sentence:

The teeth are one of the most neglected parts of the body. Brushing teeth can remove almost 50% of your dental woes.

good/and/oral/health/dental/hygiene/need/inculcated/to/at an early age/be 1

ii) Report the dialogues to complete the paragraph that follows: 2x1=2

Customer: Why is the meal so sour?

Waiter: Nobody has complained for five days sir about the meal.

Customer: What! Where is the Manager?

Waiter: He has gone to some other hotel to take dinner, sir.

One day, a customer was taking dinner in a hotel. He asked the waiter why ...**(a)**.....
The waiter told him...**(b)**..... At this the customer was shocked and wanted to know where the manager was. The waiter replied that he had gone to some other hotel to take dinner.

SECTION D: LITERATURE TEXTBOOK (26 MARKS)

8. Read the given excerpts and answer the questions briefly, for **ANY TWO** excerpts, of the three, given.

(2X4=8)

A. "Water, water, everywhere,
And all the boards did shrink:
Water, water, everywhere,
Nor any drop to drink." (The Rime of the Ancient Mariner)

- | | | |
|------|--|---|
| I. | Explain the phrase: "Water, water, everywhere, And all the boards did shrink." | 1 |
| II. | What sufferings did the sailors undergo? | 1 |
| III. | What do you mean by shrink? | 1 |
| IV. | Why was there no drop to drink? | 1 |

B. CAESAR: 'Cowards die many times before their deaths;
The valiant never taste of death but once.
Of all the wonders that I yet have heard,
It seems to me most strange that men should fear;
Seeing that death, a necessary end, Will come when it will come.' (Julius Caesar)

- | | | |
|------|--|---|
| I. | Whom is Caesar speaking to? Why does he say these words? | 1 |
| II. | What fears has the listener expressed? | 1 |
| III. | What is the basis for the fears expressed? | 1 |
| IV. | How do cowards die and why? | 1 |

C. "Get all your friends and acquaintances to stop using the Ouija Board, and then we'll start helping you to write."
(A Shady Plot)

- | | | |
|------|--|---|
| I. | Identify the speaker of the above lines. | 1 |
| II. | To whom has this request been made? | 1 |
| III. | Why had the speaker made this request? | 1 |
| IV. | How has the speaker been 'helping you to write'? | 1 |

9. Answer **any five** of the following six questions in about 40 words each. (5x2=10)

- | | | |
|------|--|--|
| I. | "Ali is a true example of love, faith and sacrifice." Elaborate. | |
| II. | What was the motive behind Mrs. Packletide's decision to shoot a tiger? | |
| III. | Why is Helen the ghost, upset with people using Ouija boards? | |
| IV. | 'A real message from the real Sebastian Shultz', says Michael. What does he mean by this? | |
| V. | How do both poets, Percy Bysshe Shelley in 'Ozymandias' and William Shakespeare in ' Not Marble, nor the Gilded Monuments' portray the inevitable decay of human achievements over time? | |
| VI. | Why did the poet allow the snake to finish drinking water? | |

10. Answer any one of the following two questions in about 150 words.

(1x8=8)

- I. Compare and contrast the depiction of personal determination in the face of challenges in ‘ Patol Babu, Film Star’ by Satyajit Ray and ‘Two Gentlemen of Verona’ by A.J. Cronin. How do the protagonists in each story demonstrate flexibility and what lessons can be learned about the importance of determination?

OR

- II. Even though both, the frog from Vikram Seth’s poem ‘The Frog and the Nightingale’ and Abel’s children from the play ‘ The Dear Departed’ display greed, there are differences. Elaborate, in about 150 words, how the greed of the frog and that of Abel’s children differ in motivation, actions, relationship, and consequences.
